



Seagram Building

Location New York, New York

German American architect Ludwig Mies van der Rohe's Seagram Building, completed in 1958, was the most influential skyscraper of the second half of the 20th century. Standing 516 ft (157 m) tall, it is a minimalist masterpiece—slim and entirely uniform—with no trace of the massive masonry of its predecessors. Constructed of

a steel frame from which hang dark-tinted glass walls, the building has a series of bronze beams running vertically up its 38 stories to accentuate the underlying structure. The interior is lavish, featuring marble and more of the bronze and rich brown glass, complete with travertine lobby and elegant elevators. In front of the building sits a large, open granite plaza with two rectangular fountains, forming an urban landscape that allows the building space and light.

Sharp Centre for Design

Location Toronto, Canada

The Sharp Centre for Design, completed in 2004 to designs by Alsop Architects, is an extension to the Ontario College of Art and Design. One of the most immediately striking structures of the 21st century, it is a rectangular, two-story, steel-frame box, 275 ft (84 m)

▲ THE BLACK-AND-WHITE UNDERSIDE OF THE SHARP CENTRE FOR DESIGN

long, 101 ft (31 m) wide, and 30 ft (9 m) high. Its aluminum walls are painted white, to which seemingly random black squares have been added. Held 85 ft (26 m) off the ground by six pairs of angled, multicolored steel columns, it sits directly above the otherwise unexceptional brick buildings of the preexisting college. It is linked to a box, painted dark gray, containing elevators and stairs.